Executive Summary Report

1. Five Key Business Insights

#	Insight	Evidence
1	**Technology is the profit engine.** It delivers 37.5% of sales ($4.74M) but 45% of all profit ($664K) at a 14.0% margin. Furniture earns 32.5% of sales yet only a 6.9% margin ($285K).	**Profits Per Category** column chart and the Category slicer. Office Supplies adds $518K (13.7% margin).
2	**Sales have almost doubled, but margin has not moved.** Sales grew from $2.26M (2011) to $4.30M (2014), +90%, while margin only edged from 11.0% to 11.7%. November and December contribute 24.8% of annual sales; February is the weakest month.	**Total Sales & Total Profits** line chart (Order Year slicer; monthly view shows the Nov peak of $555K in 2014).
3	**Heavy discounting destroys profit.** Orders with no discount earn a 25.3% margin. Discounts of 21–40% lose 17.3%, 41–60% lose 57.6% and 60%+ lose 138.6%. Discounts above 20% account for about $815K of losses across 22% of order lines.	**Discount Band** field (matrix / column chart of Profit Margin % by Discount Band) and the Loss Flag column.
4	**Strong sales do not guarantee profit: Tables loses money.** Tables sell $757K but makes a loss of $64K (–8.5% margin). Copiers is the largest profit contributor ($259K, 17.1% margin) and Paper has the highest margin (24.2%).	**Profit by Sub-Category** bar chart (Tables is the only negative bar).
5	**Profit is concentrated in three markets, and EMEA lags.** APAC ($3.59M sales, $436K profit, 12.2%), EU ($2.94M, $373K, 12.7%) and US ($2.30M, $286K, 12.5%) lead. EMEA is the weak spot at a 5.4% margin on $806K, while Canada earns 26.6% on only $67K.	**Sales Per Market** column chart and the **Market Performance** metrics table (margin colour scale).

2. Three Business Risks

#	Risk	Evidence
R1	**Discount-driven margin erosion.** About 24.5% of all order lines are loss-making, totalling roughly $921K in losses. Unless discounting is controlled, growth in sales will continue to dilute profit.	**Discount Band** analysis; **Profit by Sub-Category.**
R2	**Loss-making and low-margin markets.** EMEA runs at 5.4% and Southeast Asia at 2.0%. Turkey (–$98K), Nigeria (–$81K) and the Netherlands (–$41K) each lose money, so expansion there could deepen losses.	**Metrics table** and **Sales Per Country.**
R3	**Growth without margin gains, plus Q4 dependence.** Margin is stuck near 11–12% despite +90% sales. A quarter of sales fall in two months, and low-margin Furniture (32.5% of sales, 6.9% margin) dilutes overall profitability as it grows.	**Total Sales & Total Profits** line chart; **Profits Per Category**.

3. Three Business Opportunities

#	Opportunity	Evidence from the dashboard
O1	**Scale the high-margin markets.** Canada (26.6%), North Asia (19.5%) and Central Asia (17.6%) earn far above the 11.6% average on small sales bases, so extra volume there is highly profitable.	**Metrics table**; Region and Market views.
O2	**Push high-margin products.** Copiers (17.1%), Accessories (17.3%), Labels (20.4%) and Paper (24.2%) outperform the average, and Technology earns 14.0%.	**Profit by Sub-Category**; **Profits Per Category**.
O3	**Grow the Consumer base and fill the quiet months.** Consumer drives 51.5% of sales ($6.51M, 11.5% margin) and Home Office earns a slightly better 12.0%. February, April and July are consistently soft, which leaves room for targeted off-peak campaigns.	**Sales by Segment** chart and the **Total Sales & Total Profits** line chart.

1. Recommended Actions for Management

#	Recommendation	Supported by	Success measure
1	**Cap discounts at 20% and require manager approval above it.** Report the share of sales discounted above 20% every month.	Insight 3, Risk R1: discounts above 20% lose about $815K.	% of sales discounted above 20%; margin by Discount Band.
2	**Reprice, re-source or rationalise Tables.** Start with price increases and lower discounts; drop the worst-performing products if the margin stays negative.	Insight 4: Tables lose $64K (–8.5%) on $757K of sales.	Tables margin moves from negative to at least break even.
3	**Run a turnaround review of Turkey, Nigeria and the Netherlands**, covering pricing, freight and discounts. Hold expansion in EMEA and Southeast Asia until margins improve.	Insight 5, Risk R2: EMEA 5.4%, Southeast Asia 2.0%, three loss-making countries.	Profit by country; EMEA and Southeast Asia margin.
4	**Shift the sales mix toward Technology** (Copiers, Accessories, Phones) with bundles and cross-selling and treat Furniture as a margin-repair category.	Insight 1, Opportunity O2: Technology gives 45% of profit at 14.0%; Furniture earns 6.9%.	Technology share of sales; overall profit margin.
5	**Plan Q4 stock, staffing and logistics early**, and launch Feb, Apr and Jul campaigns capped at a 20% discount to smooth demand.	Insight 2, Risk R3, Opportunity O3: Nov–Dec is 24.8% of sales; off-peak months are weak.	Off-peak share of annual sales; Q4 stock-outs.
6	**Invest in Canada, North Asia and Central Asia**, and add Profit Margin next to Sales in the executive KPI pack so growth is judged on profit, not just volume.	Opportunity O1, Risk R3: margins of 26.6%, 19.5% and 17.6% against an average of 11.6%.	Sales growth in these markets at or above current margin.